Software Agile Planning and Control

UTM
UNIVERSITI TEKNOLOGI MALAYSIA

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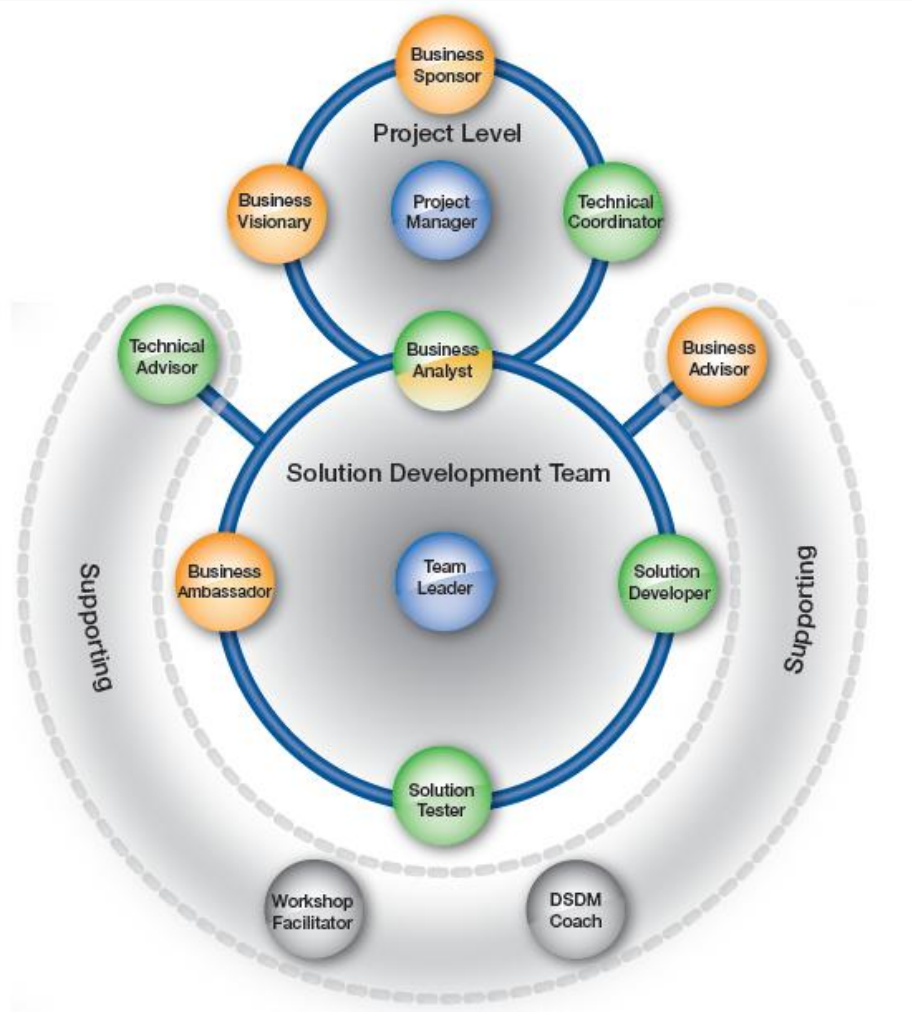
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Outline

- Introduction
- DSDM Team
- DSDM Products
- Project Planning Concepts
- Testing Concepts
- Tracking and Control Concepts
- Planning throughout the Life cycle
- Planning and Quality

Introduction : The DSDM Team

- **Clear Roles & Responsibilities**: DSDM assigns well-defined roles covering business, technical, management, and process interests to ensure balanced representation across the project.
- **Collaboration & Communication**: All team members work closely together, breaking down barriers and fostering effective communication to drive project success.
- **Empowered, Self-Organising Teams**: The best solutions come from teams that are empowered to self-organise and take responsibility within agreed boundaries.

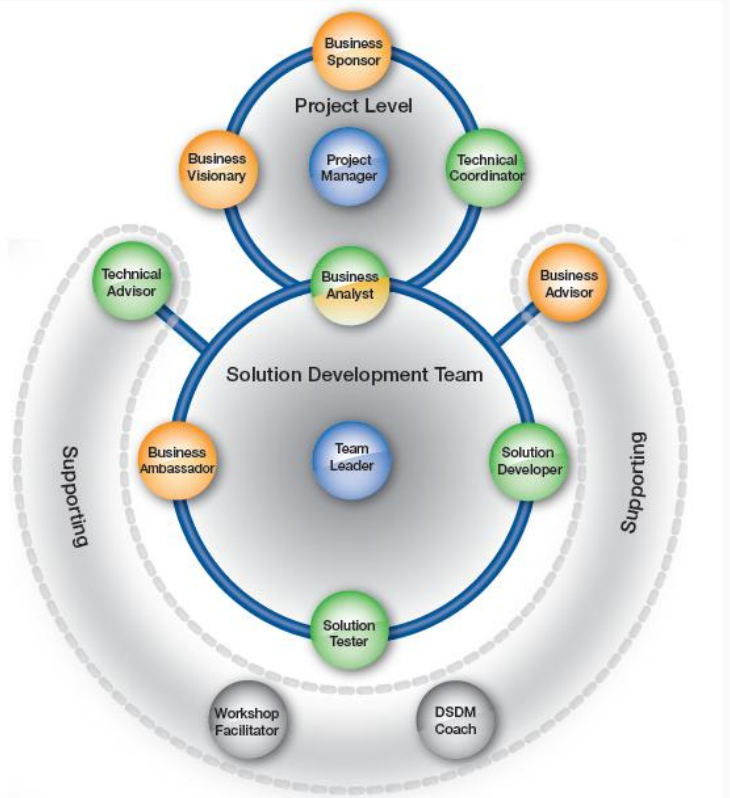


DSDM Team – Role Category

- **Colour Scheme (Roles of Interest):** **Orange** = Business view, **Green** = Solution/technical view, **Blue** = Management/leadership view, **Grey** = Process view, Mixed = Covers multiple views.

- **Role Categories:**
  - **Project-level roles**: Business Sponsor, Business Visionary, Technical Coordinator, Project Manager, Business Analyst → direct, manage, and govern the project.
  - **Solution Development Team roles**: Business Ambassador, Solution Developer, Solution Tester, Business Analyst, Team Leader → engine room of the project, shaping and building the solution.
  - **Supporting roles**: Business Advisors, Technical Advisors, Workshop Facilitator, DSDM Coach → provide guidance, expertise, and support as needed.

- **Role Flexibility:** One person can hold multiple roles, or a role may be shared by several people, provided communication and collaboration remain effective.



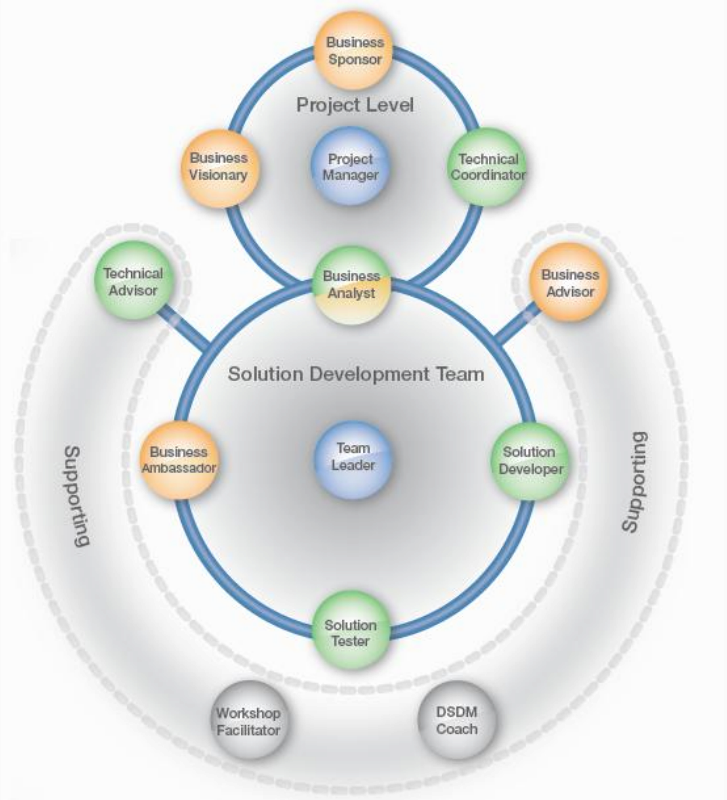
The Roles – Business View

Business Sponsor

- Senior-most project-level business role and project champion.
- Owns the Business Case and project budget, ensuring continued justification.
- Must hold authority to resolve business issues and make financial decisions.

Business Visionary

- Provides a single clear vision for the project, avoiding confusion and misdirection.
- Interprets the needs of the Business Sponsor and communicates them to the team.
- Guides strategic direction, ensuring the solution delivers the expected business benefits.



Business Ambassador

- Key representative of the business within the Solution Development Team.
- Provides detailed input on requirements and prioritisation during Foundations and development.
- Acts as the main business decision-maker, ensuring the evolving solution is fit for purpose.

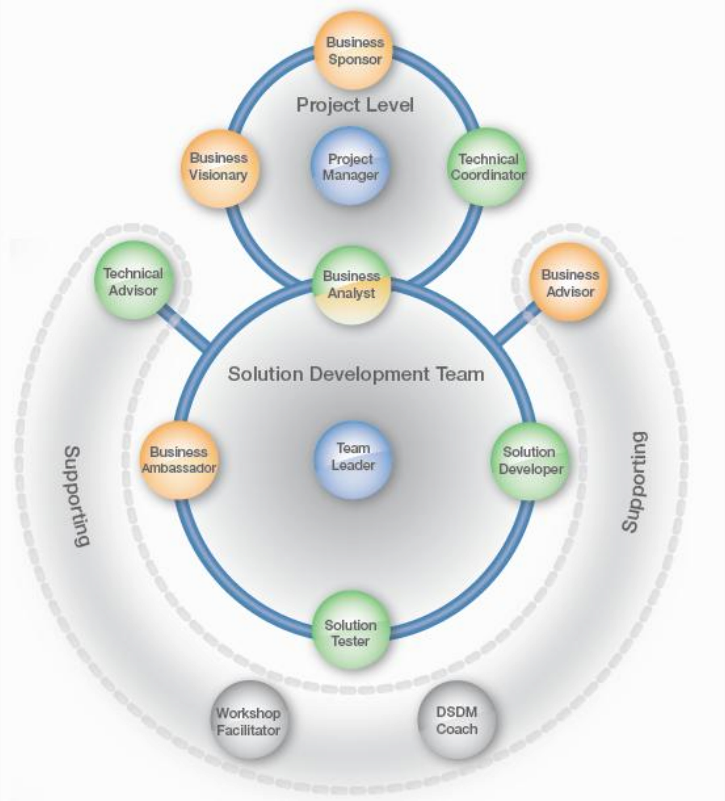
Business Advisor

- Specialist or subject matter expert who supports solution development or testing.
- Often peers with the Business Ambassador, providing expert input when needed.
- May be end users, beneficiaries, or specialists (e.g., legal/regulatory advisors).

The Roles – Management/leadership View

Project Manager

- Provides high-level Agile-style leadership and manages the project environment.
- Coordinates business and technical delivery but leaves detailed planning to the team.
- Adopts a facilitative style, ensuring empowerment rather than command-and-control.
- Responsible for project delivery across all phases (Foundations → Deployment).



Team Leader

- Acts as a servant-leader for the Solution Development Team, ensuring collaboration and objectives are met.
- Plans and coordinates detailed product delivery with the team.
- Typically elected by peers as the best person to lead during a project stage.
- Often combines this role with another Solution Development Team role (e.g., Business Analyst, Developer, Tester).

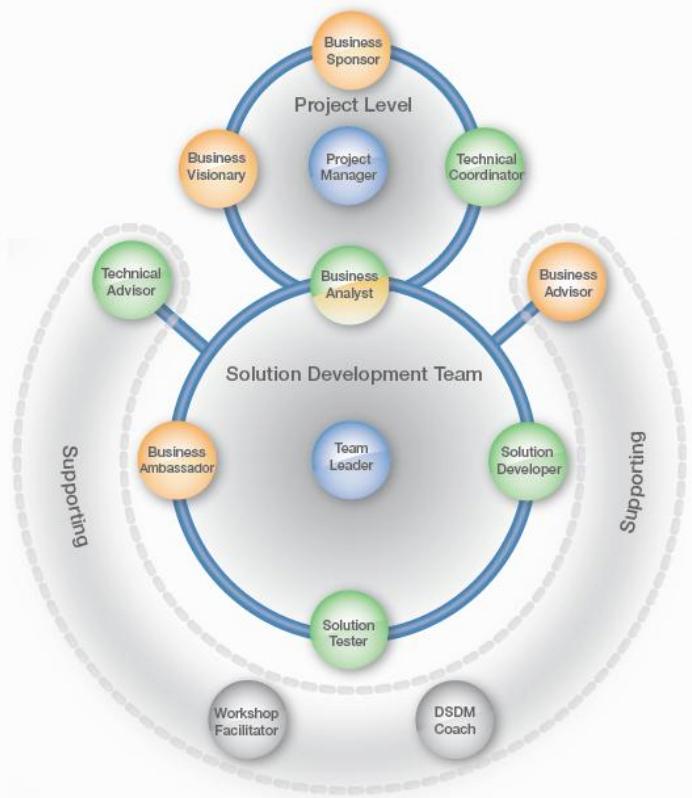
The Roles – Solution/technical view

Technical Coordinator

- Acts as the project's technical authority, ensuring technical coherence and standards.
- Provides guidance on technical decisions and innovation.
- Equivalent to the Business Visionary, but from a technical perspective.

Business Analyst

- Bridges business and technical roles, ensuring accurate day-to-day solution decisions.
- Makes sure business needs are understood and represented by the team.
- Facilitates communication between business users and the development team.



Solution Developer

- Interprets business requirements and builds solution increments.
- Ensures functional and non-functional needs of the business are met.

Technical Advisor

- Provides specialist technical expertise and input as needed.
- Often represents operational perspectives like change management, support, and maintenance.
- Ensures solutions are practical and sustainable for ongoing operations.

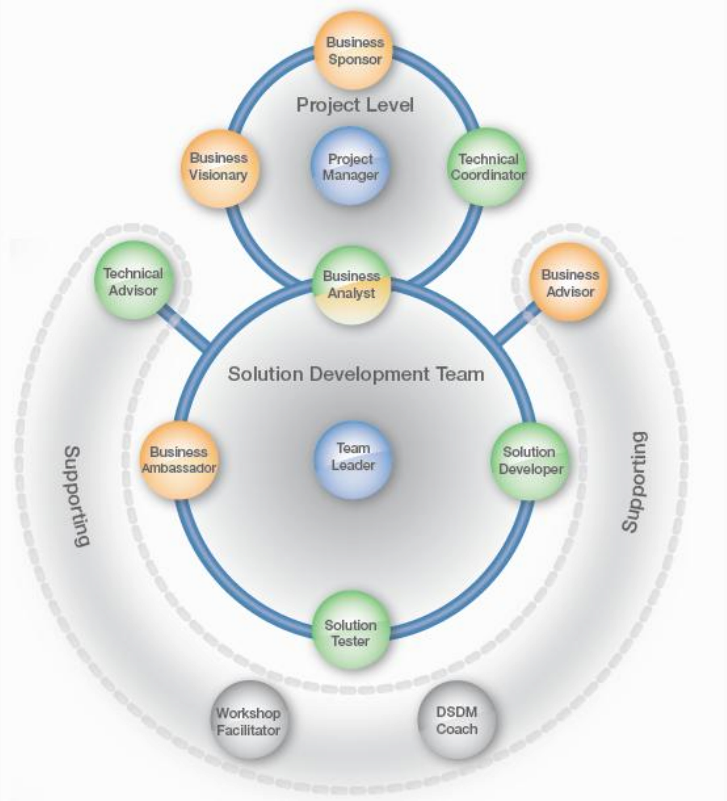
Solution Tester

- Fully integrated into the team to perform continuous testing.
- Validates the solution against agreed strategy throughout development.
- Ensures quality and business fitness of the evolving solution.

The Roles – Process view, Mixed

Workshop Facilitator

- Plans, organises, and facilitates workshops to achieve objectives quickly.
- Ensures effective collaboration within a compressed timeframe.
- Ideally independent of the workshop's outcome.



DSDM Coach

- Supports teams with limited DSDM experience.
- Helps members maximise benefits of the approach within organisational context and constraints.
- Guides adoption of DSDM practices effectively.

DSDM Team – Summary

- DSDM classifies roles in two dimensions: categories and interests
- **Role Categories**: Project-level roles, Solution Development Team roles and Supporting roles
- **Four Areas of Interest**: Business interest, Solution / Technical interest, Management interest, and Process interest
- The **Business Analyst** role is special: it **spans both business and technical interests**, acting as a bridge between project level and solution team.

The DSDM Products

- DSDM Products are the project deliverables
- There are 4 categories of DSDM Products:-

- **Business-focused products (Orange):**

Capture and justify the business needs, priorities, and expected benefits.

- **Solution-focused products (Green):**

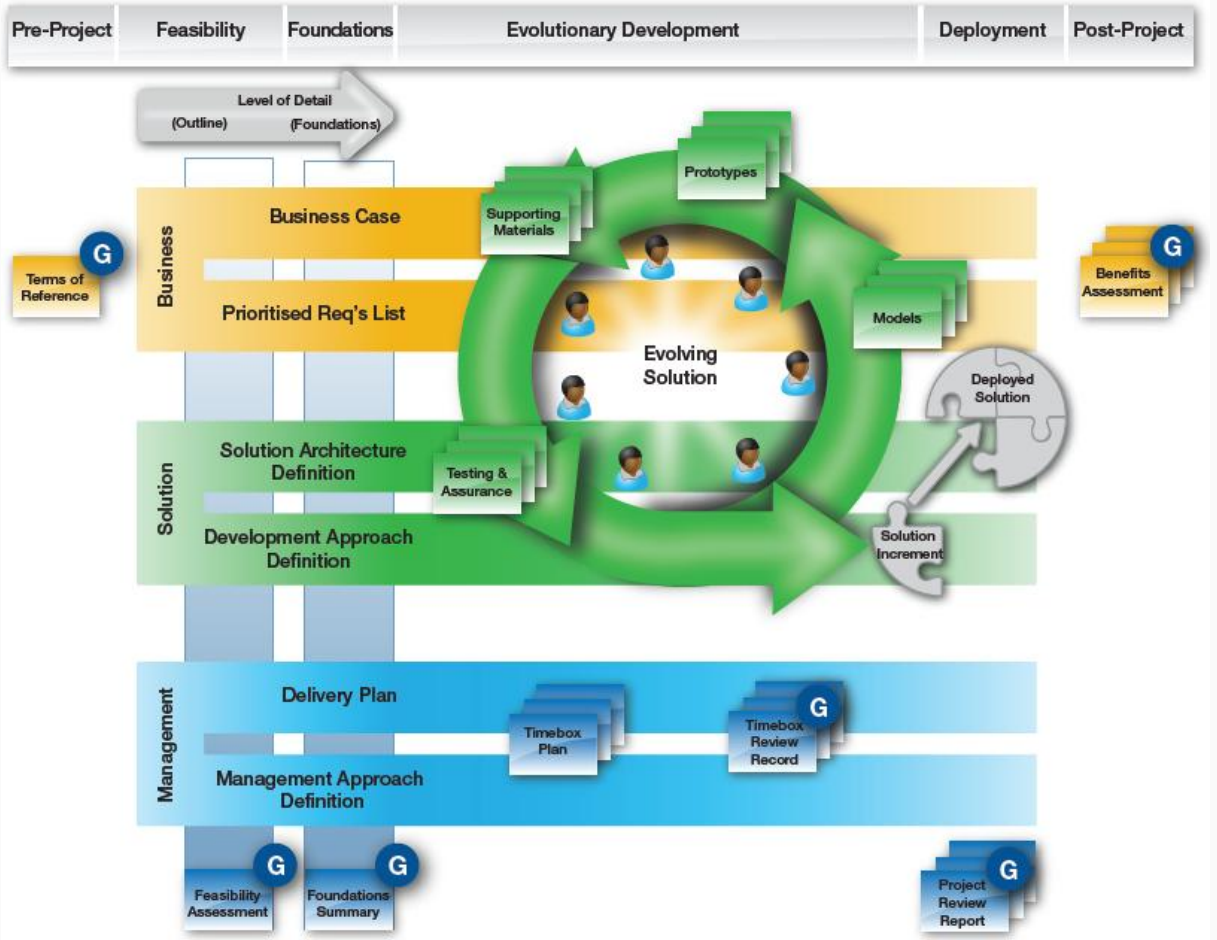
Define, build, and validate the evolving solution and its supporting artefacts.

- **Management/control products (Blue):**

Provide planning, monitoring, and governance to ensure controlled delivery.

- **Governance Products (marked "G"):**

Key checkpoints used for approvals, compliance, and demonstrating alignment with organisational standards.



Click here for all example of template.

DSDM Products – Term of Reference

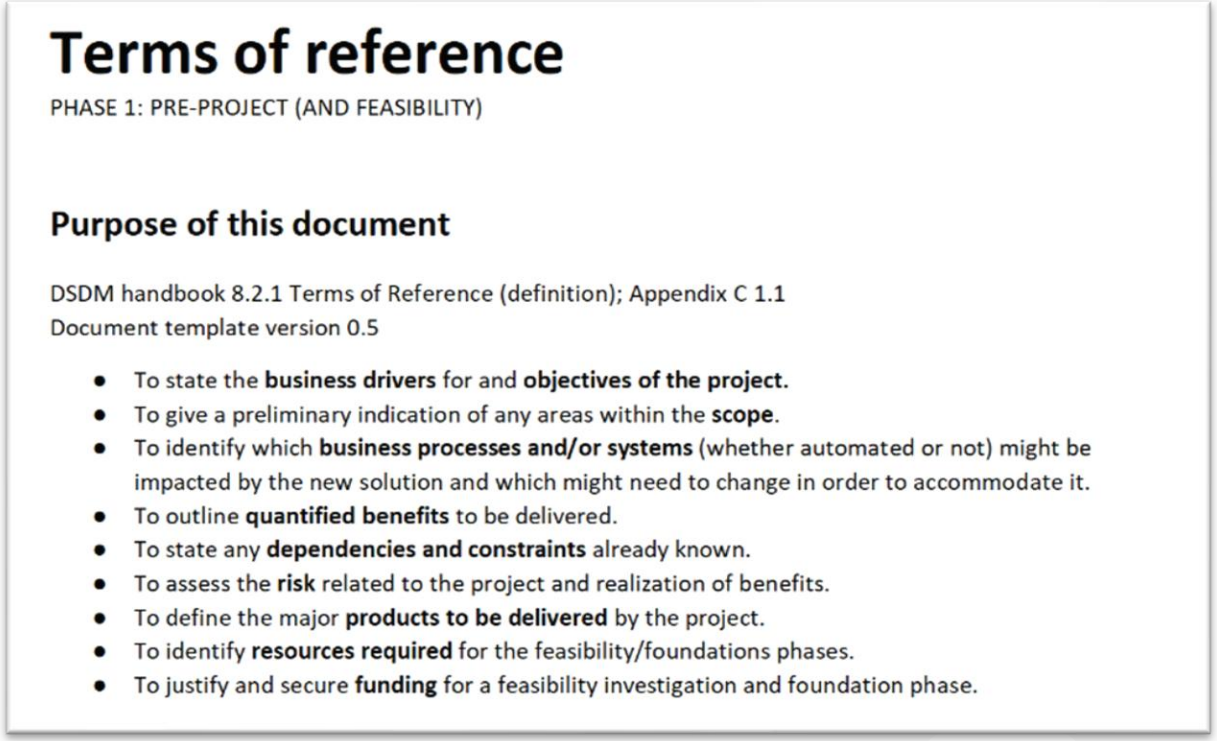
Overview

- **High-level definition** of the overarching business driver and top-level objectives of the project.
- Primary purpose: to scope and justify the **Feasibility phase**.
- Acts as a governance product since it may be used for portfolio-level prioritisation and approval.
- A document summarising the project's business justification, objectives, scope, constraints, stakeholders, and alignment with organisational strategy.

Example of Terms of Reference product

- Click here:

1.1 Pre-project - Terms of reference (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Terms of reference

PHASE 1: PRE-PROJECT (AND FEASIBILITY)

Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.2.1 Terms of Reference (definition); Appendix C 1.1
Document template version 0.5

- To state the **business drivers** for and **objectives of the project.**
- To give a preliminary indication of any areas within the **scope**.
- To identify which **business processes and/or systems** (whether automated or not) might be impacted by the new solution and which might need to change in order to accommodate it.
- To outline **quantified benefits** to be delivered.
- To state any **dependencies and constraints** already known.
- To assess the **risk** related to the project and realization of benefits.
- To define the major **products to be delivered** by the project.
- To identify **resources required** for the feasibility/foundations phases.
- To justify and secure **funding** for a feasibility investigation and foundation phase.

DSDM Products – Business Case

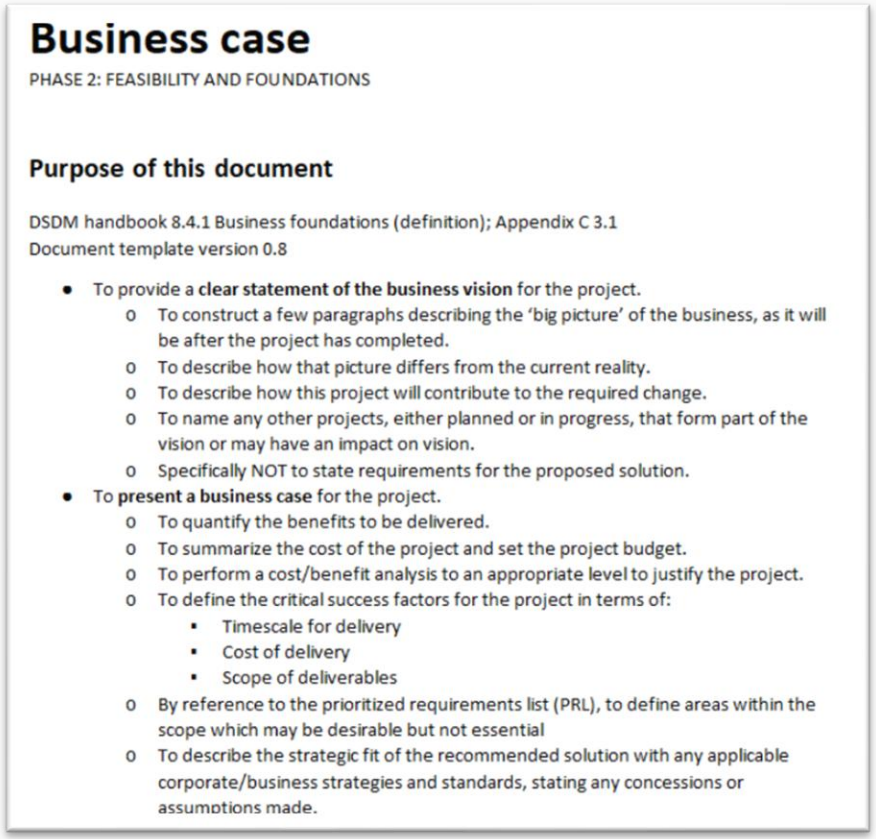
Overview

- The Business Case provides a vision and a justification for the project from a **business perspective**.
- The business vision describes a **changed business** as it is expected to be, **incrementally** and **at the end of the project**.
- The justification for the project is typically based on an investment appraisal determining whether the value of the solution to be delivered by the project warrants the cost to produce, support and maintain it into the future, all within an acceptable level of risk.
- **Baselines** of the Business Case are typically created first as an outline by the end of Feasibility, then as a basis for approval of development by the end of Foundations.
- It is formally reviewed at the end of each Project Increment in order to determine whether further work is justified.

Example of Business Case product

- Click here:

3.1 Foundations - Business case (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Business case

PHASE 2: FEASIBILITY AND FOUNDATIONS

Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.4.1 Business foundations (definition); Appendix C 3.1
Document template version 0.8

- To provide a **clear statement of the business vision** for the project.
  - To construct a few paragraphs describing the 'big picture' of the business, as it will be after the project has completed.
  - To describe how that picture differs from the current reality.
  - To describe how this project will contribute to the required change.
  - To name any other projects, either planned or in progress, that form part of the vision or may have an impact on vision.
  - Specifically NOT to state requirements for the proposed solution.
- To **present a business case** for the project.
  - To quantify the benefits to be delivered.
  - To summarize the cost of the project and set the project budget.
  - To perform a cost/benefit analysis to an appropriate level to justify the project.
  - To define the critical success factors for the project in terms of:
    - Timescale for delivery
    - Cost of delivery
    - Scope of deliverables
  - By reference to the prioritized requirements list (PRL), to define areas within the scope which may be desirable but not essential
  - To describe the strategic fit of the recommended solution with any applicable corporate/business strategies and standards, stating any concessions or assumptions made.

DSDM Products – Prioritised Requirements List

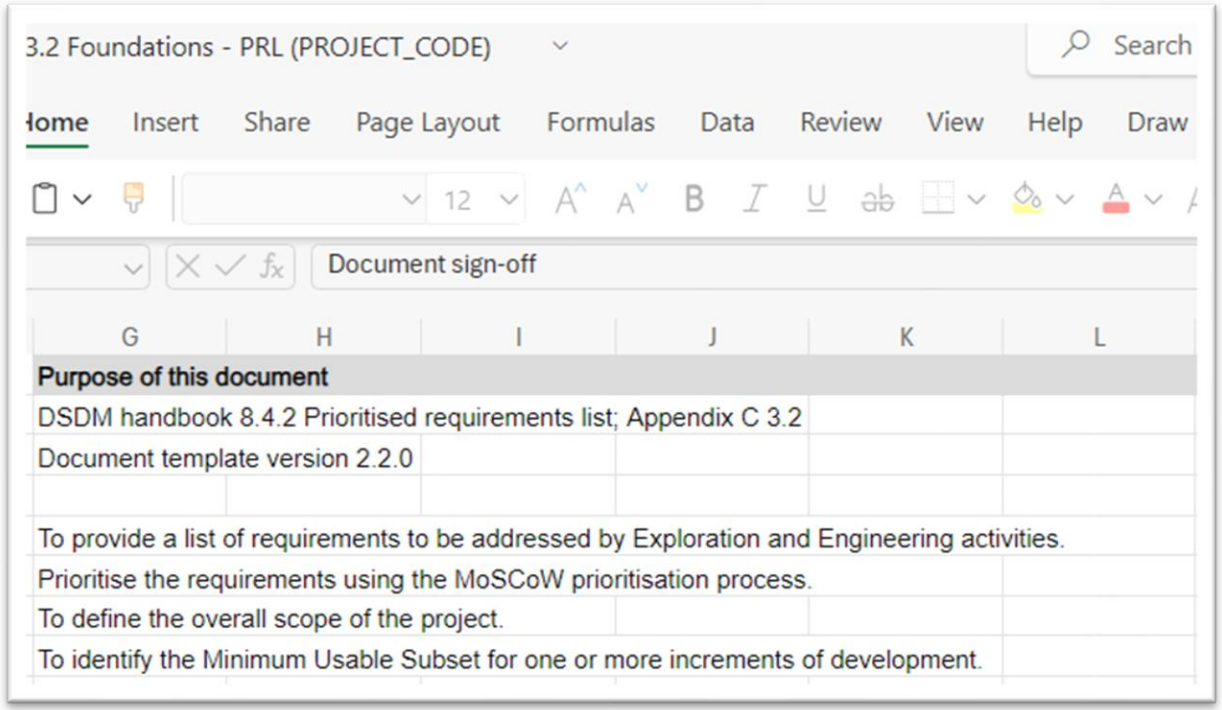
Overview

- The PRL outlines, at a high level, the requirements the project must address.
- It shows the priority of each requirement in meeting project objectives and business needs.
- Consideration of requirements starts in **Feasibility**.
- A baseline PRL, created by the end of **Foundations**, defines the project scope.
- After Foundations, changes naturally occur in **depth** (detail) as the project progresses.
- Changes in **breadth** (adding, removing, or significantly altering high-level requirements) must be formally controlled.
- Control is necessary to ensure alignment with the **business vision** and to maintain scope discipline.

Example of PRL product

- Click here:

3.2 Foundations - PRL (PROJECT_CODE).xlsx



DSDM Products – Solution Architecture Definition

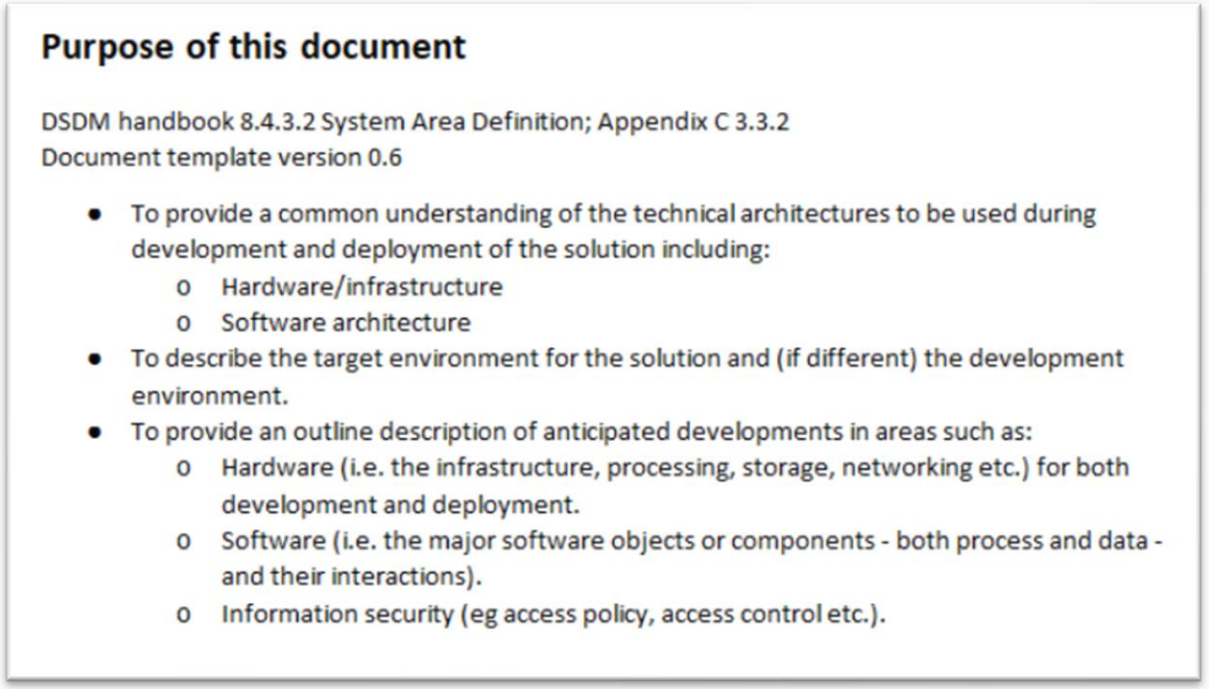
Overview

- Provides a **high-level design framework** for the solution.
- Covers both **business** and **technical aspects** of the solution.
- Describes the solution to a sufficient level of detail, ensuring the **scope is clear**.
- Ensures the framework is flexible and does **not restrict evolutionary development**.

Example of SAD product

- Click here:

3.3.2 Foundations - SAD system (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.4.3.2 System Area Definition; Appendix C 3.3.2
Document template version 0.6

- To provide a common understanding of the technical architectures to be used during development and deployment of the solution including:
  - Hardware/infrastructure
  - Software architecture
- To describe the target environment for the solution and (if different) the development environment.
- To provide an outline description of anticipated developments in areas such as:
  - Hardware (i.e. the infrastructure, processing, storage, networking etc.) for both development and deployment.
  - Software (i.e. the major software objects or components - both process and data - and their interactions).
  - Information security (eg access policy, access control etc.).

DSDM Products – Development Approach Definition

Overview

- Provides a **high-level definition** of tools, techniques, customs, practices, and standards.
- Guides the **evolutionary development** of the solution.
- Defines how **solution quality** will be assured.
- Includes a **strategy for testing and review** as a key part of the approach.
- Ensures that development is **structured, consistent, and aligned** with project goals.

Example of DAD product

- Click here:

3.3.3 Foundations - DAD development (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.4.3.3 Development Approach Definition; Appendix C 3.3.3
Document template version 0.6

- To define standards and styles to be applied during development of the solution
- To describe practices to be adopted by the solution development teams in the development of those technical products
- To define the configuration management process for the technical deliverables of the solution
- To describe how, and against what criteria, the outputs of the project will be reviewed and tested.
- To describe testing and/or review techniques that will be applied in the development phases of the project.

DSDM Products – Delivery Plan

Overview

- Provides a **high-level schedule** of project increments.
- Includes, at minimum, details of the **first/imminent increment**.
- Breaks down increments into **timeboxes** that make up each increment.
- Typically does **not cover task-level detail**.
- May include task-level detail only when:
- Tasks are done by people **outside the Solution Development Team**, or
- Tasks occur **before the Solution Development Team is formed**.

Example of Delivery Plan product

- Click here:

3.5 Foundations - Delivery plan (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Delivery plan

PHASE 2: FEASIBILITY AND FOUNDATIONS

Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.4.5 Delivery Plan; Appendix C 3.5
Document template version 0.5

To describe and present:

- The incremental nature of the project and the dates associated with the increments.
- The dates for deployment of the solution and, where applicable, subsets of it.
- The schedule of timeboxes, together with an indication of the focus of each Development Timebox.
- The timing and dependencies of any activities not planned within the Development Timeboxes.
- The allocation of resources to timeboxes and other activities.
- An identification of the contingency associated with one or more of the key constraints of time, resource/cost or, preferably, scope.

DSDM Products – Management Approach Definition

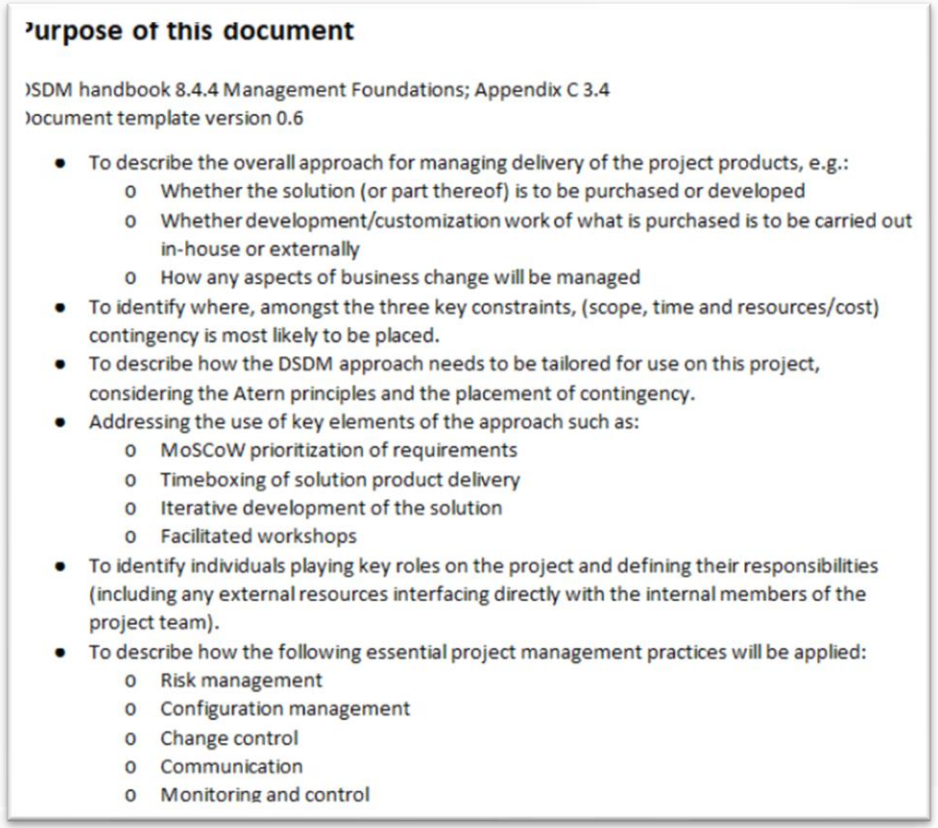
Overview

- Defines the **overall management approach** for the project.
- Describes how the project will be **organized and planned.**
- Explains how **stakeholders will be engaged** throughout the project.
- Outlines how **progress will be demonstrated** and, if needed, reported.
- Created during **Feasibility** and baselined at the end of **Foundations**
- Evolves only when:
- **Circumstances change**, or
- **Review identifies improvements** in the approach.

Example of MAD product

- Click here:

3.4 Foundations - MAD management (PROJECT_CODE).docx



ʼurpose of this document

)SDM handbook 8.4.4 Management Foundations; Appendix C 3.4
)ocument template version 0.6

- To describe the overall approach for managing delivery of the project products, e.g.:
  - Whether the solution (or part thereof) is to be purchased or developed
  - Whether development/customization work of what is purchased is to be carried out in-house or externally
  - How any aspects of business change will be managed
- To identify where, amongst the three key constraints, (scope, time and resources/cost) contingency is most likely to be placed.
- To describe how the DSDM approach needs to be tailored for use on this project, considering the Atern principles and the placement of contingency.
- Addressing the use of key elements of the approach such as:
  - MoSCoW prioritization of requirements
  - Timeboxing of solution product delivery
  - Iterative development of the solution
  - Facilitated workshops
- To identify individuals playing key roles on the project and defining their responsibilities (including any external resources interfacing directly with the internal members of the project team).
- To describe how the following essential project management practices will be applied:
  - Risk management
  - Configuration management
  - Change control
  - Communication
  - Monitoring and control

DSDM Products – Feasibility Assessment

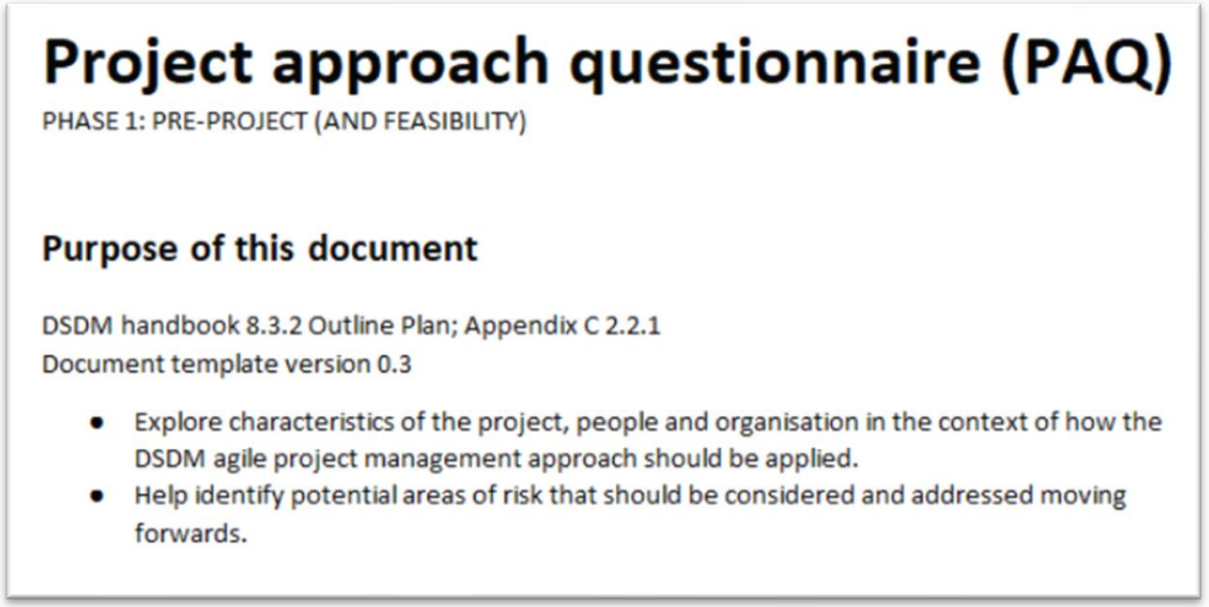
Overview

- Provides a **snapshot** of evolving business, solution, and management products.
- Conducted at the **end of the Feasibility phase**.
- Ensures products are **mature enough** to support decision-making.
- Helps determine whether the project **is likely to be feasible or not**.
- Can be expressed as:
- A **baselined collection of products**, or
- An **executive summary** covering key aspects.

Example of Feasibility Assessment product

- Click here:

2.2.1 Feasibility - PAQ (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Project approach questionnaire (PAQ)

PHASE 1: PRE-PROJECT (AND FEASIBILITY)

Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.3.2 Outline Plan; Appendix C 2.2.1
Document template version 0.3

- Explore characteristics of the project, people and organisation in the context of how the DSDM agile project management approach should be applied.
- Help identify potential areas of risk that should be considered and addressed moving forwards.

DSDM Products – Foundations Summary

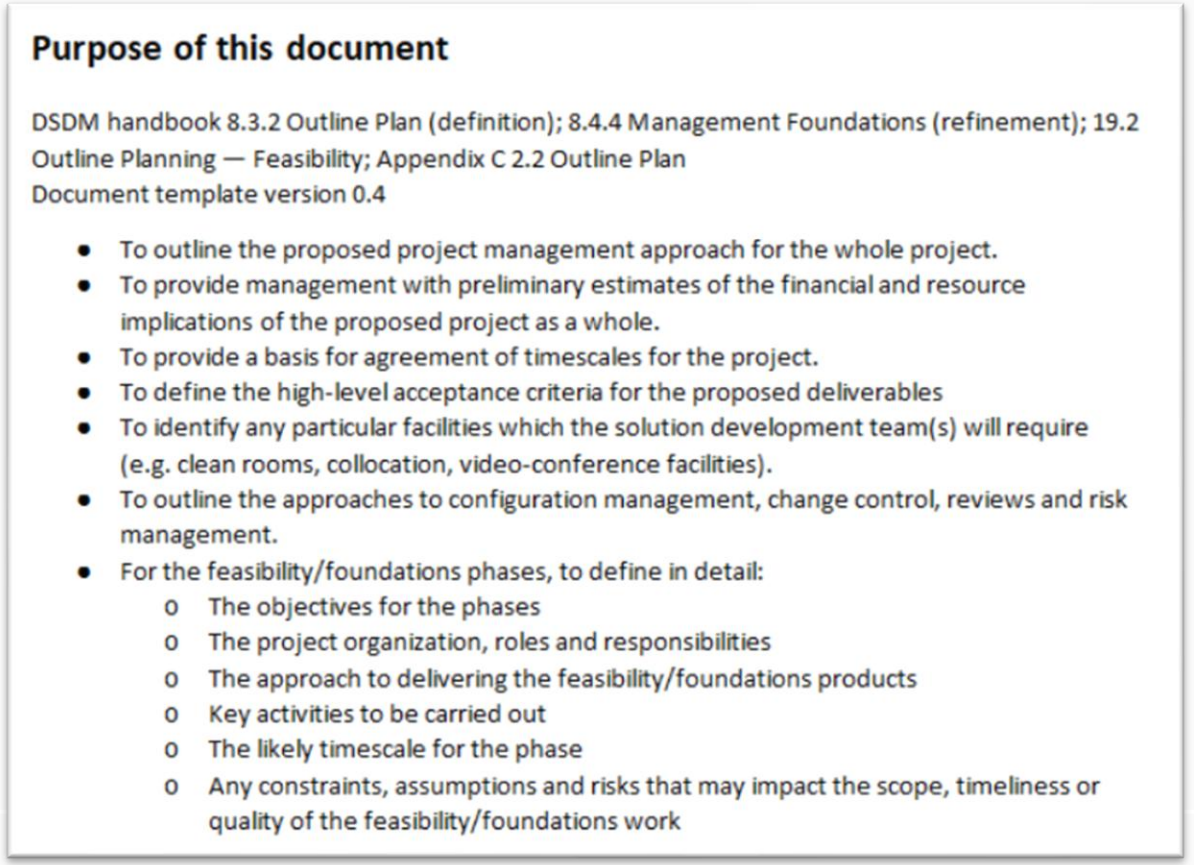
Overview

- Provides a **snapshot** of evolving business, solution, and management products.
- Conducted at the **end of the Foundations phase**.
- Ensures products are **mature enough** to support decision-making.
- Helps determine if the project is **likely to deliver the required return on investment (ROI)**.
- Can be expressed as:
- A **baselined collection of products**, or
- An **executive summary** covering key aspects.

Example of Foundations Summary product

- Click here:

2.2 Feasibility - Outline plan for foundations (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.3.2 Outline Plan (definition); 8.4.4 Management Foundations (refinement); 19.2 Outline Planning — Feasibility; Appendix C 2.2 Outline Plan
Document template version 0.4

- To outline the proposed project management approach for the whole project.
- To provide management with preliminary estimates of the financial and resource implications of the proposed project as a whole.
- To provide a basis for agreement of timescales for the project.
- To define the high-level acceptance criteria for the proposed deliverables
- To identify any particular facilities which the solution development team(s) will require (e.g. clean rooms, collocation, video-conference facilities).
- To outline the approaches to configuration management, change control, reviews and risk management.
- For the feasibility/foundations phases, to define in detail:
  - The objectives for the phases
  - The project organization, roles and responsibilities
  - The approach to delivering the feasibility/foundations products
  - Key activities to be carried out
  - The likely timescale for the phase
  - Any constraints, assumptions and risks that may impact the scope, timeliness or quality of the feasibility/foundations work

DSDM Products – Evolving Solution

Overview

- Comprises all **appropriate components** of the ultimate solution.
- Includes **intermediate deliverables** needed to explore requirements and build the solution.
- At any given time, components may be:
- **Complete**,
- A **baseline of a partial solution** (Solution Increment),
- Or A **work in progress**.

Overview

- May include valuable items such as:
- Models,
- Prototypes,
- Supporting materials,
- Testing and review artefacts.
- At the end of each **Project Increment**, the Solution Increment is:
- **Deployed into live use**, and
- Becomes the **Deployed Solution**.

DSDM Products – Timebox Plan

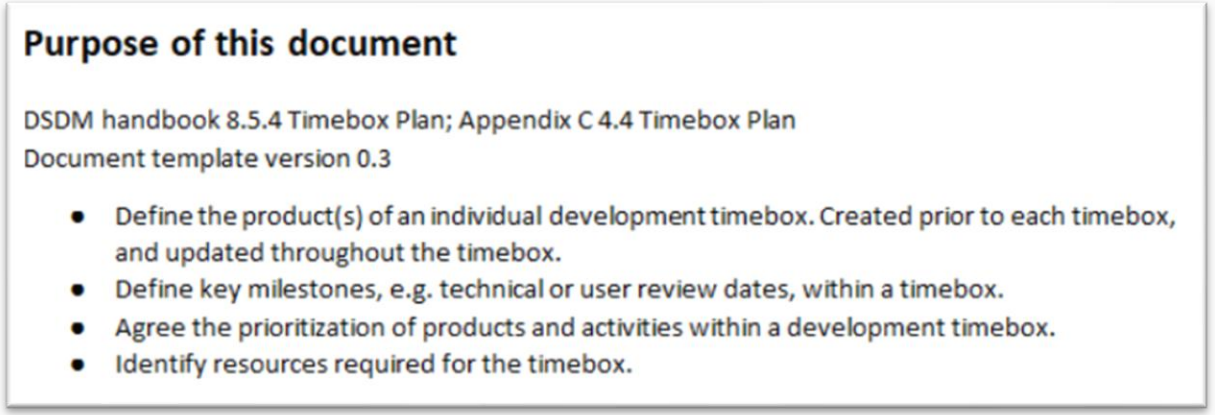
Overview

- Provides **detailed depth** for each Timebox identified in the Delivery Plan.
- Defines the **objectives** and **deliverables** of the Timebox.
- Specifies the **activities** and **resources** needed to achieve deliverables.
- Created by the **Solution Development Team**.
- Often represented on a Team Board as:
- Work to do,
- Work in progress,
- Work done.
- Updated frequently — **at least daily during Stand-ups**.

Example of Timebox Plan product

- Click here:

4.4 EED - Timebox plan (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.5.4 Timebox Plan; Appendix C 4.4 Timebox Plan
Document template version 0.3

- Define the product(s) of an individual development timebox. Created prior to each timebox, and updated throughout the timebox.
- Define key milestones, e.g. technical or user review dates, within a timebox.
- Agree the prioritization of products and activities within a development timebox.
- Identify resources required for the timebox.

DSDM Products – Timebox Review Record

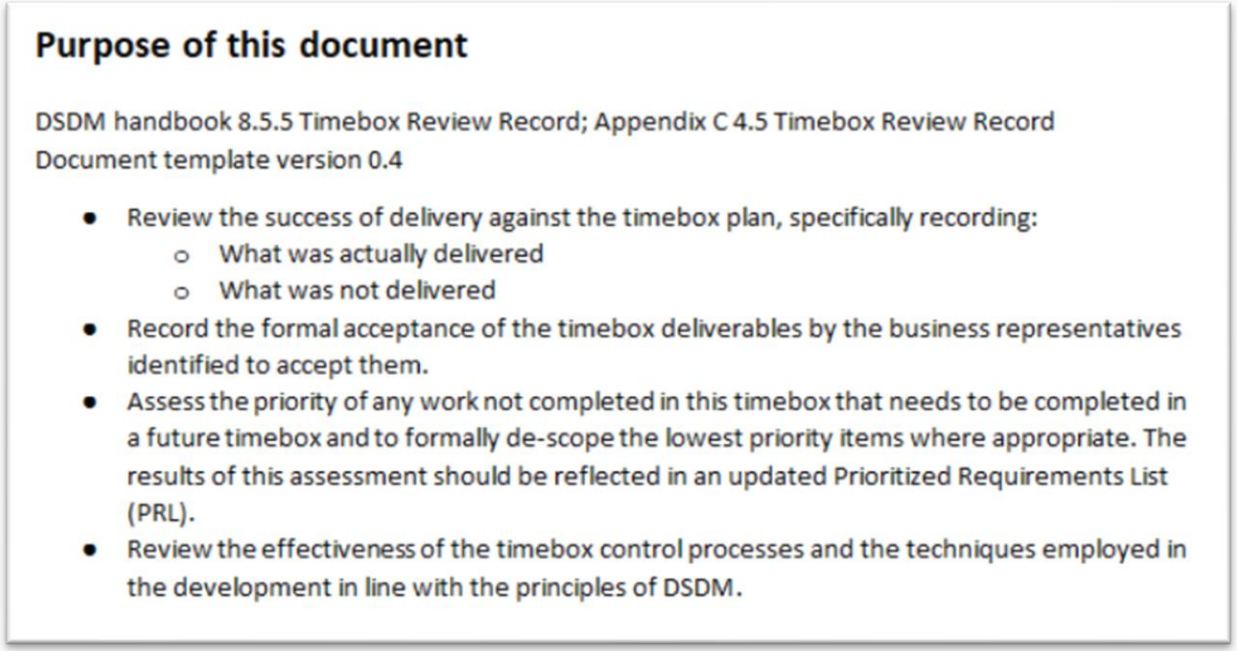
Overview

- Captures **feedback** from each review held during a Timebox.
- Describes **what has been achieved** up to that point.
- Records **feedback** that may influence **future plans**.
- In regulated environments, may serve as a **formal, auditable record**.
- Includes review comments from **Business Advisors** and other roles.
- Acts as a **governance product** when formalized.

Example of Timebox Review Record product

- Click here:

4.5 EED - Sprint review record (sprint nn) (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.5.5 Timebox Review Record; Appendix C 4.5 Timebox Review Record Document template version 0.4

- Review the success of delivery against the timebox plan, specifically recording:
  - What was actually delivered
  - What was not delivered
- Record the formal acceptance of the timebox deliverables by the business representatives identified to accept them.
- Assess the priority of any work not completed in this timebox that needs to be completed in a future timebox and to formally de-scope the lowest priority items where appropriate. The results of this assessment should be reflected in an updated Prioritized Requirements List (PRL).
- Review the effectiveness of the timebox control processes and the techniques employed in the development in line with the principles of DSDM.

DSDM Products – Project Review Report

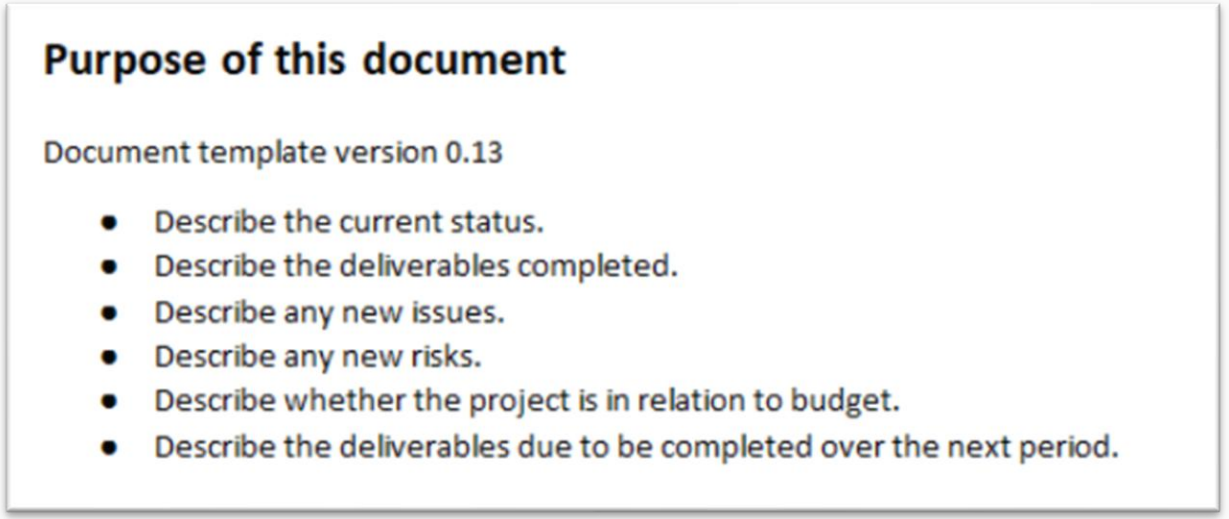
Overview

- A **single document** updated incrementally at the end of each Project Increment.
- Includes new sections relevant to each increment.
- Purpose at the end of each Project Increment:
- Capture **feedback** from solution reviews – confirm what has and hasn't been delivered.
- Capture **learning points** from retrospectives (processes, practices, roles, responsibilities).
- Describe **business benefits** gained through proper use of the delivered solution.
- At project closure:
- A **final retrospective** is carried out, covering the **entire project**.
- Informed by records from each Project Increment.

Example of Project Review Report product

- Click here:

3.6.1 Foundations - Project status report template (PROJECT_CODE).docx



Purpose of this document

Document template version 0.13

- Describe the current status.
- Describe the deliverables completed.
- Describe any new issues.
- Describe any new risks.
- Describe whether the project is in relation to budget.
- Describe the deliverables due to be completed over the next period.

DSDM Products – Benefits Assessment

Overview

- Describes how **benefits have actually accrued** after the solution is in live operation.
- Conducted following a **period of real use**.
- For projects with **long-term benefits** (as per the Business Case):
- Multiple Benefits Assessments may be produced.
- These are done on a **periodic basis**.
- Aligned with the **timeframe used to justify the investment**.

Example of Benefit Assessment product

- Click here:

4.3.1 EED - Benefits realisation plan (PROJECT_CODE).docx

Purpose of this document

DSDM handbook 8.5.3.1; Appendix C 4.3.1
Document template version 0.2

- Based on the benefits laid out in the business case element of the business foundations product:
  - Identify key information that can be measured after the solution or, where appropriate, partial solution has been deployed.
  - Quantify the expected value for each measure at various points in the future
- Determine how and when the baseline of the current state of the metrics will be made for future comparison.
- Identify and plan activities required to ensure that any new or changed working practices are properly embedded.
- Describe how and when future measurements will be taken, to demonstrate whether target metrics are being achieved and thus whether predicted benefits are being achieved.
- Describe how and when such measurements will be reported to the business sponsor and other interested parties. The Benefits Realization Report is the product intended to convey this information.

DSDM Products – Summary

- Products act as guidelines for communicating project information clearly and effectively.
- They are not mandatory in all projects only used where they add value.
- Formal documents are useful when governance, compliance, auditability or stakeholder alignment is needed (beyond just shared understanding).
- The most important goal is ensuring stakeholders & participants understand what is needed and what will be delivered, and ensuring quality is assured.
- Only create documents / products if they help achieve communication, alignment, clarity — avoid wasting time on unnecessary documentation.

Planning and Control

Introduction

- Although DSDM (like all Agile) values responding to change over strictly following a plan, it emphasises high-level planning to shape and guide the project without micromanaging who does what and when.
- Planning in DSDM begins with agreeing on a strategy (how the solution will evolve) and includes:

• **Incremental delivery** through project increments and timeboxes Agile Business Consortium

• **Quality assurance integration**, ensuring review and testing are built into development rather than tacked on later

Planning and Control

- To support planning and control, DSDM defines:

• **Three planning concepts**: outcome-based planning; planning to sensible horizons; plan & re-plan using best estimates

• **Six testing concepts**, such as integrated testing, collaborative testing, repeatable testing, prioritised testing, independent testing, and test-driven approaches

• **Four tracking & control concepts**, including timeboxing with outcome measurement, transparency of process/progress, embracing change, and management by exception

Project Planning Concepts

Concept	Definition / Purpose	How it works in DSDM	Benefits / Considerations
Outcome-based planning	Focuses on delivering business value and outcomes rather than micromanaging tasks	Project Manager and project roles plan at a high level for the outcomes needed; Solution Development Teams plan within each timebox for how to achieve those outcomes.	Keeps planning aligned with business goals; enables empowerment and flexibility
Planning to sensible horizons at the right level of detail	Use shorter planning horizons for near-term work and longer horizons at higher level	Delivery Plan covers months ahead (project increment) with coarse detail; Timebox Plans cover only the next 1-4 weeks in greater detail.	Reduces wasted effort in planning unknowns too early; balance certainly and adaptability
Plan & re-plan based on best available estimates	Accepts that estimates evolve and plans must adapt.	Initial estimates are rough; as more is learned (especially during Foundations / early timeboxes), plans are refined and re-planned	Allows adaption to reality, accommodates change, improves forecast accuracy over time.

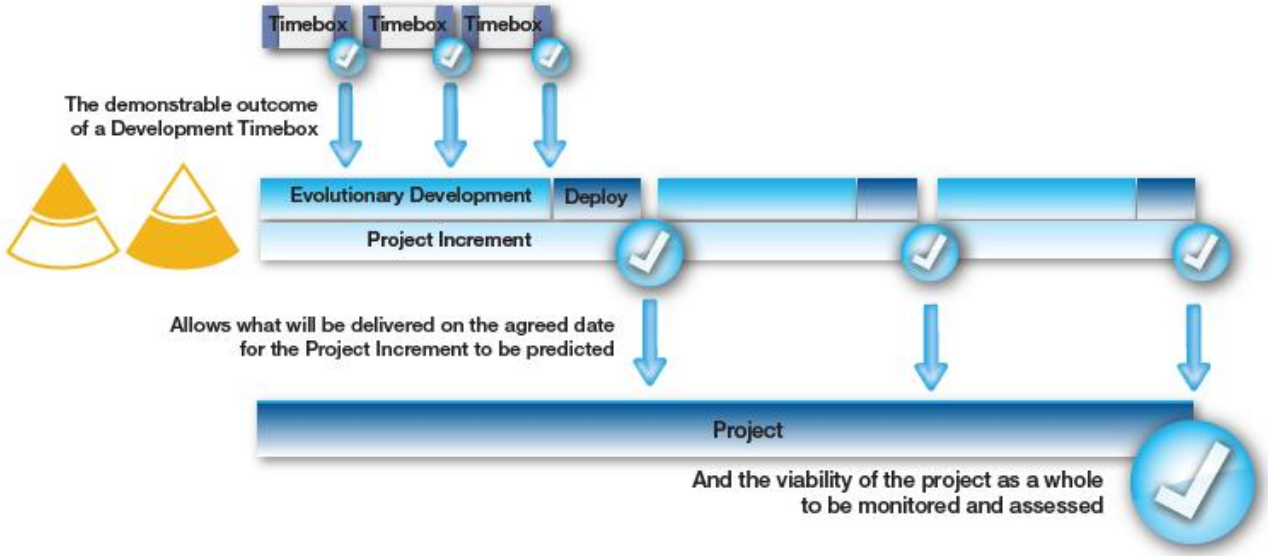
Testing Concepts

Concept	Purpose / Essence	Key Practices / Approach	Benefits & Challenges
Testing integrated Throughout	Embeds testing into very timebox rather than leaving it as a separate phase	Plan a test strategy early; include test activity in same timebox as development; aim for the solution to be deployable at the of timebox where possible	Finding defects early reduces cost & risk ; may not always be fully testable every timebox depending on complexity
Collaborative Testing	Involve all stakeholders in testing to accelerate test-fix cycles	Business, technical, development, and testing roles collaborate in planning, execution, and review of tests	Improves shared understanding and quality; can require extra coordination and communication
Repeatable Testing	Ensure that tests can be rerun reliably	Every timebox tests new features and regression tests of earlier features; use automation where possible	Maintains quality baseline and prevents regressions; automation setup effort may be significant
Prioritised Testing	Not all tests can run all the time- choose which are most critical	Use risk, likelihood, impact criteria and MoSCow to decide which tests must/should/could be run classify defects similarity	Helps focus efforts on high-risk areas; lower priority tests may be delayed and some defects tolerated
Independent Testing	A separate perspective ensures objectivity	Someone other than the creator of a feature must test it; business and advisor roles may help as independent testers.	Helps reduce bias and catch misunderstandings; may require extra resource planning
Test-Driven Development (TDD)	Shift testing to lead the development cycle	Define tests first, then write code to pass them; tests help clarify requirements	Improves code quality and clarity; may slow down initial development and requires discipline

Tracking and Control Concepts

Timeboxing and Outcome-Based Measurement

- **Timeboxes** provide a **nested planning structure** to support outcome-based measurement
- Focus is on **what has been delivered** as part of a **Solution Increment** at the end of a Timebox.
- Each Solution Increment is **demonstrated** and **formally accepted** by the Business Ambassador or Business Visionary.
- This ensures the delivered outcome is **fit for purpose** and valid for measurement.
- Comparing **actual outcomes** with **planned outcomes** provides a clear indicator of:
- Whether the Project Increment is on track.
- Whether the project as a whole is viable.



- Discipline at the Timebox level gives control over:
- Each **Timebox**,
- Each **Project Increment**, and
- The **entire project**.

Tracking and Control Concepts

Transparency of Process and Progress

- **Transparency at Timebox level** is achieved through:
- **Team Board**
- **Daily Stand-up**
- These ensure visibility and control for the **Solution Development Team.**

Aspect	Team Board	Daily Stand-up
Purpose	Shows the detailed plan and ongoing activities	Provides team updates and short-term planning
Visibility	Makes tasks and ownership visible to everyone	Makes progress and blockers visible
Focus	Who is doing what, effort required, and issues noted	What has been done, what will be done, and blockers
Outcome	Helps track fulfillment of requirements in Solution Increment	Ensures collaborative problem-solving and proactive action
Frequency	Continuously visible	Happens daily

Tracking and Control Concepts

Responding to Change

- In a **dynamic business environment**, change is:
- **Inevitable** and should be **welcomed** as part of refining the solution.
- Must be **controlled** to stay aligned with business needs, delivery timelines, and quality.

Aspect	Project Level	Solution Development Team Level
Responsibility	Business Visionary	Solution Development Team, with support from Business Ambassadors & Advisors
Type of Change	High-level requirements (breadth)	Detailed requirements (depth)
Control	Formal approval required	Managed at team's discretion
Alignment	Ensures solution meets business vision	Ensures solution fits evolving business needs
Formality	More formal change control	Less formal, more flexible
Constraints	Approved only if necessary and aligned with business vision	Must remain within time, cost, and quality constraints
Outcome	Maintains overall project direction and scope	Adjusts detailed solution delivery without changing scope

Tracking and Control Concepts

Management by Exception

- **Management by exception:**
- Bridges the boundaries of empowerment.
- Involves project-level roles **only when needed**.
- Ensures focus on **strategic decisions** rather than routine work.

Aspect	Team-Level Empowerment	Project-Level Escalation
Scope of Decisions	Day-to-day management within a Timebox	Wider project-level impact decisions
Authority	Solution Development Team	Project-level roles (e.g., Business Visionary, Project Manager)
Allowed Actions	De-scope **Could Have** requirements; decide on detail of work	Step in when escalation is needed
Conditions	Work remains within tolerance; Must and Should Have can be achieved without risking quality	When Must/Should requirements cannot be met or quality would be compromised
Benefits	Rapid decision-making and progress; flexibility within the team	Ensures strategic alignment and protects project outcomes
Approach	Empowerment	Guidance and oversight

DSDM Planning & Control – Summary

- **Timeboxing & Outcome-based Measurement**
- Focus on delivered outcomes (Solution Increments).
- Demonstrations & acceptance ensure progress is on track.
- **Transparency of Process & Progress**
- **Team Board** shows tasks, ownership, and issues.
- **Daily Stand-ups**: progress, plans, blockers → visibility.
- **Responding to Change**
- Change welcomed but controlled.
- **Project Level**: Business Visionary approves high-level changes.
- **Team Level**: Handles detail-level changes within constraints.
- **Management by Exception**
- Teams empowered for daily decisions within tolerance.
- Escalate only when Must/Should requirements or quality at risk.

Planning Throughout the Lifecyle



Pre-Project
- Positioning project within a portfolio.
- Initial project shaping and tentative schedule.

Feasibility
- Assess viability of project.
- Define initial strategy for iterative development with integrated testing.

Foundations
- Strategy for deployment.
- Committed timescale and costs.

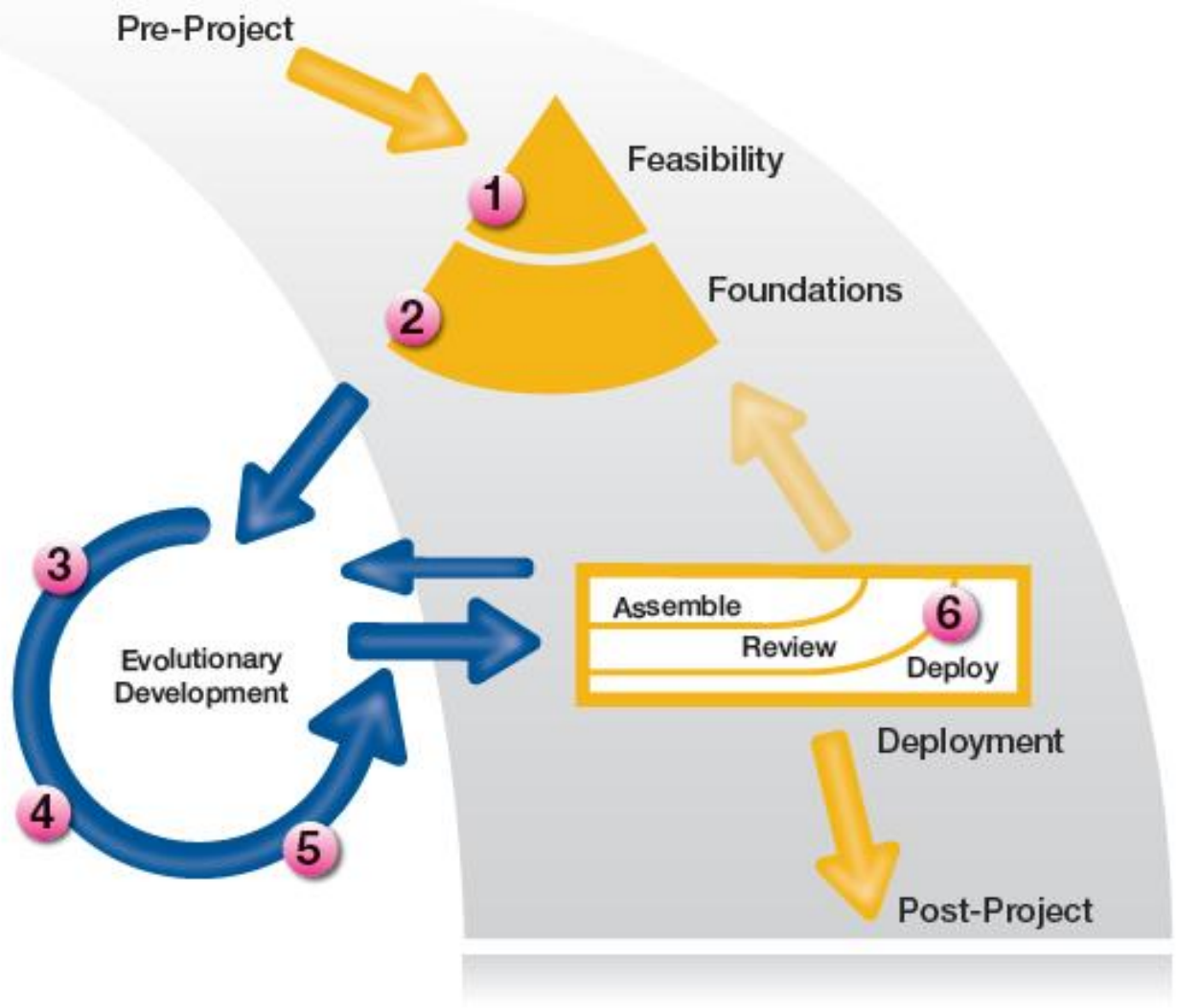
Evolutionary Development
- Iterative development with integrated testing.
- Planning development timeboxes.
- Refinement of delivery plan.

Deployment
- Assemble → Review → Deploy solution increments.
- Deliver solution into live use.

Post-Project
- Realization of benefits.
- Ongoing review of outcomes.

Planning and Quality

Quality control and assurance in the DSDM process



1. High-Level Risk Analysis (Feasibility)

- Identify high-level risks (performance, security, resilience).
- Establish how quality will be assured early.

2. Planning & High-Level Analysis (Foundations)

- Refine vague requirements into high-level, clear requirements.
- Encourage collaboration between Business, Solution Developers, and Testers.
- Shared understanding ensures solution can meet business needs.

3. Detailed Analysis & Planning (Evolutionary Development)

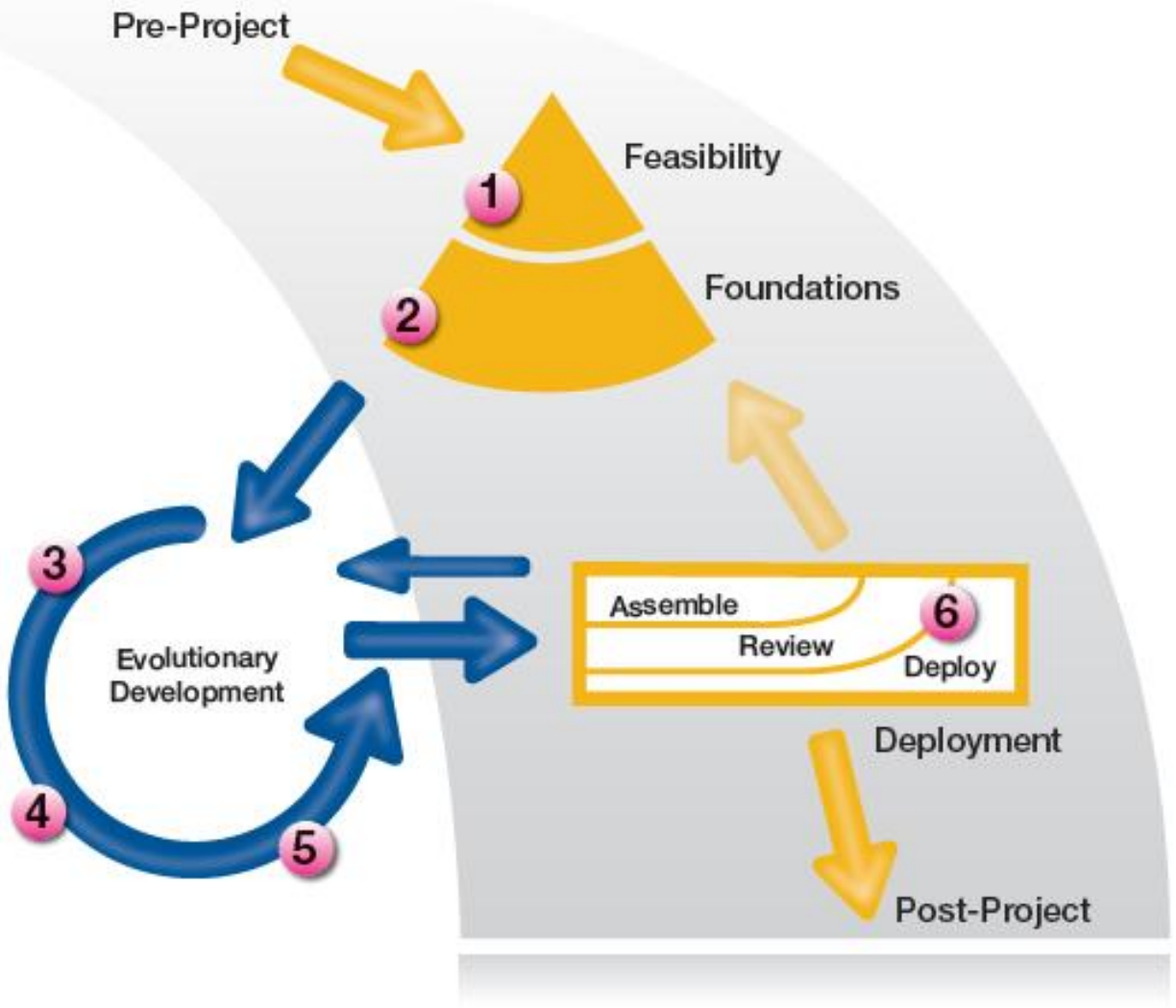
- Define detailed requirements and acceptance criteria.
- Consider multiple perspectives before starting development.
- Prepare for quality assurance activities.

4. Prepare & Run Tests

- Tests designed collaboratively for each feature.
- Test execution captures detailed, repeatable results.
- Lightweight documentation supports transparency and sharing.

Planning and Quality

Quality control and assurance in the DSDM process



5. Assess Quality & Impact

- Identify defects early, take corrective actions.
- Priorities defects blocking progress.
- Manage residual defects by scheduling remediation or deferring to next Timebox.

6. Final End-to-End Testing & Assuring Implementation (Deployment)

- Test complete solution end-to-end.
- Validate non-functional requirements (e.g., performance, usability).
- Confirm solution is fit for purpose before deployment.
- Post-deployment: assure success, design rollback or backup strategies.



THANK YOU

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